

The Last Train

Raat ke 11:47 baj rahe thay jab Ayan station par akela khara tha. Baarish tez ho rahi thi aur platform par sirf ek yellow light jal rahi thi.

Usay ghar pohanchne ke liye aakhri train ka intezar tha.

Achanak station ki ghari ruk gayi.

11:47.

Ayan ne apni watch dekhi — woh bhi 11:47 par ruk chuki thi.

Phir door se train ki awaaz aayi.

Train platform par aa kar ruki, lekin us par koi driver ya passenger nazar nahi aa raha tha. Darwaza khud-ba-khud khul gaya.

Ayan ne kuch seconds socha, phir train mein chadh gaya.

Andar har seat khaali thi, magar ek seat par ek purani diary rakhi thi.

Usne diary kholi.

“Agar tum ye diary parh rahe ho, to train tumhein tumhari manzil par nahi, tumhare past mein le ja rahi hai.”

Ayan ka dil tez dharakne laga.

Train chal padi.

Khidki ke bahar shehar ki jagah purani galiyan nazar aane lagin. Phir train ek chhote se ghar ke saamne ruk gayi.

Ayan ne khidki se bahar dekha.

Woh ghar uska bachpan ka ghar tha.

Darwaza khula aur ek chhota bachcha bahar nikla.

Ayan ne use pehchan liya.

Woh khud tha.

Bachcha aasman ki taraf dekh kar muskura raha tha.

Ayan ko achanak yaad aaya ke bachpan mein uska ek bada sapna tha — writer banne ka.

Lekin waqt ke saath usne woh sapna chhor diya tha.

“Past ko badalne ki zaroorat nahi. Bas future ko dobara likhna shuru karo.”

Ayan ki aankhon mein aansu aa gaye.

Train dobara chal padi.

Jab woh platform par wapas aaya to ghari 11:48 dikha rahi thi.

Sirf ek minute guzra tha.

Ayan ne diary apne bag mein rakhi aur ghar ki taraf chal diya.

Agli subah usne apna laptop khola aur apni pehli story likhna shuru kar di.

Us story ka naam tha:

“The Last Train.”